

WHAT TO DO WHEN THE ANGEL LEAVES THE HOUSE

***DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE**

****DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO TECHNICIAN**

TEXT: [Luke 1:26-38](#) (NKJV) *“Now in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent by God to a city of Galilee named Nazareth, ²⁷to a virgin betrothed to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. The virgin’s name was Mary. ²⁸And having come in, the angel said to her, “Rejoice, highly favored one, the Lord is with you; blessed are you among women!” ²⁹But when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and considered what manner of greeting this was. ³⁰Then the angel said to her, “Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. ³¹“And behold, you will conceive in your womb and bring forth a Son, and shall call His name JESUS. ³²“He will be great, and will be called the Son of the Highest; and the Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David. ³³“And He will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of His kingdom there will be no end.” ³⁴Then Mary said to the angel, “How can this be, since I do not know a man?” ³⁵And the angel answered and said to her, “The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Highest will overshadow you; therefore, also, that Holy One who*

is to be born will be called the Son of God. ³⁶*“Now indeed, Elizabeth your relative has also conceived a son in her old age; and this is now the sixth month for her who was called barren.* ³⁷*“For with God nothing will be impossible.”* ³⁸*Then Mary said, “Behold the maidservant of the Lord! Let it be to me according to your word.” And the angel departed from her.”*

INTRO: Angels are introduced to the human race through the venue of Scripture. As far as we know, most of us have never entertained an angel face to face. (Guy who said his wife was an angel, because she was “*Always up in the air harping about something.*”) The only time I know of in my life that I may have seen an angel is when I was a little child and a person brought food and Christmas gifts to our home. The Bible says it is possible that we could entertain angels and not even be aware of it, and most of us would like to keep it that way!

If we are going to entertain an angel we probably do not want to start with the model which: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Guards the Garden, having a flaming sword in his hand and turns 360degrees at all times – Adam encountered this model...

- Has a sword in his hand and specializes in talking to donkeys - Balaam bumped into this model...
- Has six wings and can only cry “*Holy, Holy, Holy!*” - Isaiah looked this model eye to eye while at church...
- Carries vials of wrath to be poured out upon the earth turning the place into a toxic dump site - John the revelator came upon this model on Patmos...

If we are going to entertain an angel we would most likely want to start out with the basic two winged model that happens to be in a good mood! The very notion of angels set some people on edge but the Scripture teaches that angels are everywhere and they are sent to be ministering spirits! I believe we entertain angels every day but they are mostly the invisible model! Someone once told me that the way I drive I must wear out a guardian angel a year, which was a hateful but true thing to say!

In our Scripture text, a peasant girl from Nazareth is approached by, and carries on a conversation with an angel! The angel lets her know that God has selected her to be the vehicle through which Father God will introduce His Son into the world! Mary is somewhat alarmed by the presence of Gabriel and several things happen in just a few verses: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Mary asks a question; ***“How can this be, since I do not know a man?”*** (Lady who claimed to be pregnant by eating bird seed.)
- An answer was given; ***“The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Highest will overshadow you; therefore, also, that Holy One who is to be born will be called the Son of God.”***
- Confirmation was received; ***“Now indeed, Elizabeth your relative has also conceived a son in her old age; and this is now the sixth month for her who was called barren.”***³⁷***“For with God nothing will be impossible.”***
- A decision was reached; ***“Then Mary said, ‘Behold the maidservant of the Lord! Let it be to me according to your word.’”***
- Divine communication was cut off; ***“The angel departed from her.”***

Most people believe that when we are walking in the perfect will of God, we are supposed to be constantly hearing the voice of God. I mean after all, we used to sing about it in church, ***“And He walks with me and He talks with me and He tells me I am His own. And the joy we share as we tarry there none other has ever known.”***

I wish I could tell you that this is the way it will always be, but the truth is most of the time we have to

walk by faith. We cannot just set around on Gods lap and aggravate Him all the time!

The angel Gabriel appeared to Mary and: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Announced the intentions of the Almighty by telling her she would birth the Son of God...
- Confirmed His will by telling her she would be overshadowed by the Almighty...
- Reassured her by telling her not to be afraid because the Lord would be with her...

Then the Bible says, *“The angel departed from her.”* As far as I know this was Mary’s last communication with Gabriel! Surely if Gabriel and the Father expected this peasant girl to participate in a plan that was so far over the top, they would agree for Gabriel to camp out at Mary’s house for at least nine months and smite anyone who spoke out against the plan! Not so, Gabriel left, never to return!

This brings us to the question at hand, **what are we to do when the angel leaves the house? (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Follow through on the commitment which has been made...
- Encourage yourself in the Lord...
- Worship your way through the trial...
- Keep on keeping on...

I. FOLLOW THROUGH ON THE COMMITMENT WHICH HAS BEEN MADE...

**(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT
SLIDE)**

When Mary told Gabriel, *“Let it be to me according to your word”* she was saying; *“I commit to you that I will follow through on what the Almighty has asked of me!”* This would not be easy! She was a peasant girl with little to no resources and she was being asked to raise a child as a single parent if necessary. At this point she did not know what Joseph might do, she just said, *“I will place my life on hold, let it be to me according to your word.”* She had made a commitment that she would follow through on, no matter what! Martin Luther King said, *“If you are not willing to die for something, you are not fit to live.”*

Being single and pregnant carried with it consequences which were far more detrimental than in this present culture. If she were pregnant and unmarried, she would likely be unmarried for the rest of her life, and she would probably be choosing a life of poverty for her and her child! Yet, she said, *“Let it be to me according to your word!”*

The promise the Angel made to Mary would: **(PLACE
ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Take nine months to come to pass...
- Place her engagement to the man of her dreams on hold...
- Exact a high personal price with regard to her public persona...

Thomas Jefferson said, *“When you do a thing, act as if all the world were watching.”*

She would be the earthly mother of Jesus for more than thirty years, and this came with the good, the bad and the ugly! The emotional roller coaster Mary would be asked to ride would experience exhilarating highs and dangerous lows. The emotional highs and lows which Mary experienced vicariously through her son, included: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Turning water into wine, then crying out for a drink on the cross...
- Forgiving an adulterous woman condemned to death, then being rejected by the religious establishment...
- Healing ten lepers, then being betrayed by a disciple...
- Feeding five thousand with a little boy's lunch, then not having a place to lay His head...
- Healing of Peter's mother in law, then having to appoint a guardian for His own mother...

- Raising the dead to life, then the death of the cross...

How in the world could Mary have endured such a thing? She made a commitment to Gabriel which she would make good on, ***“Let it be to me according to your word!”*** The commitment Mary made was a commitment to endure whatever the Lord decided to send her way, coupled with a steadfast pledge to do it with a good attitude!

CONCLUSION: (PLACE SCRIPTURES ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

Has God ever made a promise to us? If He has made a promise, He will bring it to pass. *James 1:17 (CEV) “Every good and perfect gift comes down from the Father who created all the lights in the heavens. He is always the same and never makes dark shadows by changing.”*
Hebrews 6:13-20 (CEV) “No one is greater than God. So he made a promise in his own name when he said to Abraham, ¹⁴ “I, the Lord, will bless you with many descendants!” ¹⁵ Then after Abraham had been very patient, he was given what God had promised. ¹⁶ When anyone wants to settle an argument, they make a vow by using the name of someone or something greater than themselves. ¹⁷ So when God wanted to prove for certain that his promise to his people could not be broken, he made a vow.

¹⁸ God cannot tell lies! And so his promises and vows are two things that can never be changed. We have run to God for safety. Now his promises should greatly encourage us to take hold of the hope that is right in front of us. ¹⁹ This hope is like a firm and steady anchor for our souls. In fact, hope reaches behind the curtain and into the most holy place. ²⁰ Jesus has gone there ahead of us, and he is our high priest forever, just like Melchizedek.” Psalms 105:8 (NKJV) “He remembers His covenant forever, The word which He commanded, for a thousand generations.”

What did our commitment to that promise include? I have some great counsel for those of us who have received a promise from the Lord and are currently involved in the waiting stage, keep the promise in sight and know he will perform His word!

Have we followed through properly? Hebrews 10:35-39 (NKJV) “Therefore do not cast away your confidence, which has great reward. ³⁶For you have need of endurance, so that after you have done the will of God, you may receive the promise: ³⁷“For yet a little while, And He who is coming will come and will not tarry. ³⁸ Now the just shall live by faith; But if anyone draws back, My soul has no pleasure in him.” ³⁹But we are not of those who draw back to perdition, but of those who believe to the saving of the soul.”

Bill Cosby said, *“Anyone can dabble, but once you’ve made that commitment, your blood has that particular thing in it, and it’s very hard for people to stop you.”*

II. ENCOURAGE YOURSELF IN THE LORD...

In the case of Mary, she has just received a personal message from Jehovah through the Angel Gabriel saying that she will be a central figure in the incarnation of God. Think about this, this peasant girl will be a primary figure in a story which will be told worldwide, for centuries to come, and the effects of this happening will change the lives of untold millions. Who would ever have imagined that a girl from Nazareth could ever be a part of something so far reaching? Yet, here it is, Gabriel announces that Mary will be the mother of Jesus! [Luke 2:31-33](#) (NKJV)

“You will conceive in your womb and bring forth a Son, and shall call His name JESUS.” ³²*“He will be great, and will be called the Son of the Highest; and the Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David.”* ³³*“And He will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of His kingdom there will be no end.”*

(LEAVE THE SCRIPTURE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Mary must have left this meeting on an emotional high. She was so high that she kept these things and pondered them in her heart. I

am not sure when all of this began to settle in on her but eventually she began to realize that though she was “*Blessed and highly favored of the Lord,*” the road she had been called to travel would not be easy street, in fact it would be a very, very, difficult journey.

I want you to imagine with me Mary: **(PLACE THE SLIDES ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Telling her parents she was expecting...
- Telling Joseph she was pregnant...
- Beginning to show and dealing with the criticism of her relatives, friends and community...
- Dealing with morning sickness and the discomforts of pregnancy while Gabriel was hanging out around the throne and dangling his feet in the River of Life...

I do not think it was too long before Mary started to wonder when Gabriel would be back to bring a little encouragement, but the angel had left the house and would not be back! It was now up to Mary to endure a pregnancy and

raise a child without the encouragement of an angel!

Mary must have experienced some very difficult, gloomy, discouraging, dark days! Did the fact that her path was difficult mean that she was not doing the will of God? No! A thousand times no! She was in the perfect center of the will of God but she would be called upon to walk by faith and not by sight! She would need to encourage herself in the Lord!

William Mather Lewis said, *"The abundant life does not come to those who have had a lot of obstacles removed from their path by others. It develops from within and is rooted in strong mental and moral fiber."*

One of the great tragedies in the modern church is the philosophy that one is in the will of God if things are going good and out of the will of God if things are going bad! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** What did Jesus have to say about this way of thinking? Matthew 5:11-12 (NKJV) ***"Blessed are you when they revile and persecute you, and say all kinds of evil against you falsely for My sake.***
¹²***"Rejoice and be exceedingly glad, for great is your***

reward in heaven, for so they persecuted the prophets who were before you. Matthew 10:22 (NKJV) *“You will be hated by all for My name’s sake. But he who endures to the end will be saved.”* The Disciples of Christ finally grasped this truth and lived it out following the ascension of Christ! To prove this point all one has to do is take a look at how the Disciples of Christ died: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Andrew died on a cross...
- Simon was crucified...
- Bartholomew was flayed alive...
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded...
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death...
- Thomas was run through with a lance...
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded...
- Matthew was slain by the sword...
- Peter was crucified upside down...
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows...
- Philip was hanged...
- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island called Patmos, in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea...

Paul told Timothy, 2 Timothy 3:12 (NKJV) *“All who desire to live godly in Christ Jesus, will suffer persecution.”*

Listen to what Jesus has to say about the path becoming difficult. Matthew 10:38-39 (NKJV) ***“And he who does not take his cross and follow after Me is not worthy of Me. ³⁹“He who finds his life will lose it, and he who loses his life for My sake will find it.”***

Matthew 19:29 (NKJV) ***“And everyone who has left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or wife or children or lands, for My name’s sake, shall receive a hundredfold, and inherit eternal life.”***

Trust me, Mary met with some discouraging times. Her path was not easy and our path will not be easy. If Mary were preaching this sermon she would tell us, *“Though the path become difficult, the reward will outweigh the trial!”* Mary encouraged herself in the Lord after the angel left the house, she went to see Elizabeth. I think [Mary went to see Elizabeth for five reasons: \(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME\)](#)

- To tell Elizabeth of her own promise and pregnancy...
- She was misunderstood and discouraged because of the absence of an angel speaking into her life and she knew a visit to Elizabeth’s house would help...
- She wanted to see first-hand that Elizabeth was really expecting...

- She knew that if Elizabeth was in fact pregnant she would then have proof that she had been visited by an angel...
- She knew that if Elizabeth was in fact pregnant they would be a source of encouragement to each other...

CONCLUSION:

When the angel is in the house it is not difficult to believe but *when the angel leaves the house there are two things we are going to need:*

- *To encourage ourselves in the Lord...* Mary did this by going to the house of Zachariah to confirm the pregnancy of Elizabeth! David did this when he fought Goliath! We must do this from time to time!
- *Surround ourselves with people who believe in the promise our angel has spoken to us...* Mary surrounded herself with people who believed in what the angel had said; Zachariah; Elizabeth; Joseph...

Winston Churchill said, *"Let our advance worrying become advance thinking and planning."*

III. WORSHIP YOUR WAY THROUGH THE TRIAL...

Mary was no doubt, *"Blessed and highly favored of*

the Lord,” but that did not exempt her from all the difficulty which would ordinarily surround an event like this. Once the angel left the house Mary was in for a very difficult journey: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Carrying this baby to term...
- Properly raising Jesus, the Son of God...
- Dealing with the problem of a child who is experiencing fame...
- Watching the rejection of her son as the Son of God...
- Knowing He would eventually be crucified by those He was attempting to help...

How in the world was a peasant girl from Nazareth going to equip herself to deal with the onslaught of such dire difficulty? Mary learned to deal with the difficulty early on! She made a trip to the home of Zachariah and Elizabeth and it was upon her arrival there that something extraordinary occurred. Luke 1:41 (NKJV) ***“When Elizabeth heard the greeting of Mary, that the babe leaped in her womb; and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit.”*** This turn of events sent Mary on a journey of worship which would prove to be significant in the good times and the bad times.

Mary’s worship is recorded in Luke 1:46-55 (NKJV) ***“And Mary said: “My soul magnifies the Lord,”***⁴⁷ ***And***

my spirit has rejoiced in God my Savior. ⁴⁸ *For He has regarded the lowly state of His maidservant; For behold, henceforth all generations will call me blessed.* ⁴⁹ *For He who is mighty has done great things for me, And holy is His name.* ⁵⁰ *And His mercy is on those who fear Him From generation to generation.* ⁵¹ *He has shown strength with His arm; He has scattered the proud in the imagination of their hearts.* ⁵² *He has put down the mighty from their thrones, And exalted the lowly.* ⁵³ *He has filled the hungry with good things, And the rich He has sent away empty.* ⁵⁴ *He has helped His servant Israel, In remembrance of His mercy,* ⁵⁵ *As He spoke to our fathers, To Abraham and to his seed forever.*”

This girl knew how to worship! Mary’s worship should be a pattern for all worshippers. **Mary’s worship included: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Body, soul and spirit... (Verses 46 & 47)
- Humility... (Verse 48)
- Acknowledgement of the pre-eminence of God... (Verse 49)
- Lifting up the name of the Lord... (Verse 49)
- The mighty works of God, past; present; and future... (Verses 50-55)

If we are walking through difficult times and circumstances we need to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Humble ourselves while guarding against the temptation to have a pity party...

- Acknowledge the fact that God is in charge of our lives...
- Lift up His name no matter how we feel or what we see...
- Reflect upon the works of the Lord, past; present; and future...

Worship excites the heart of God and snatches victory out of the jaws of defeat for the believer! Psalms 22:3 (NKJV) ***"You are holy, Enthroned in the praises of Israel."*** I think we could all agree that if we could get in the presence of the Lord during the difficult times, we would have a better track record of victory.

According to this scripture the way we get in His presence is to worship because he lives in the praises of His people. C.S. Lewis said, *"The most valuable thing the Psalms do for me is to express the same delight in God which made David dance."*

Psalms 100:1-5 (NKJV) ***"Make a joyful shout to the LORD, all you lands! ² Serve the LORD with gladness; Come before His presence with singing.³ Know that the LORD, He is God; It is He who has made us, and not we ourselves; We are His people and the sheep of His pasture. ⁴ Enter into His gates with thanksgiving, And into His courts with praise. Be thankful to Him, and bless His name. ⁵ For the LORD is good; His mercy is everlasting, And His truth endures to all generations."***

Here the Psalmist tells us to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Shout joyfully...
- Serve God with gladness...
- Enter His presence singing...
- Enter His gates giving thanks...
- Enter His courtyard giving Him praise...
- Always be thankful for what He has accomplished in us...

Mary knew what Paul knew when he wrote his first letter to the Church in Thessalonica. 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18 (NKJV) **“Rejoice always, ¹⁷pray without ceasing, ¹⁸in everything give thanks; for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you.”** Michael Catt said, *"If we are going to worship in Spirit, we must develop a spirit of worship."*

Gods will for Mary, you, and me is to give God thanks no matter what is going on in our lives! When the angel has left the house, we should praise God with everything in us!

We should stand ready to praise and worship the Lord no matter what the past present or future looks like and if we will there is no doubt, He will cause our divine destiny to eventually be revealed publicly! Isaiah 61:10-11 (NKJV) **“I will greatly rejoice in the LORD, My soul shall be joyful in my God; For He has clothed me with the garments of salvation, He has covered me with the robe of righteousness, As a bridegroom decks himself with ornaments, And as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.”**¹¹For

as the earth brings forth its bud, As the garden causes the things that are sown in it to spring forth, So the Lord GOD will cause righteousness and praise to spring forth before all the nations.” C.S. Lewis said, “We only learn to behave ourselves in the presence of God.”

Even though we know we should be praising and worshipping God in the good times and the bad times it is oftentimes very difficult to do. So how can we do this even though we do not feel it? **Mary: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Reflected on the word of the angel...
- Meditated on the word of the angel...
- Devoured the word of the angel...

CONCLUSION:

Mary learned to worship her way through the tough places. She discovered that if she would worship she did not need to see an angel on a daily basis for the promise to manifest itself. If we are going to worship our way through our difficulty we must devour His Word! Jeremiah 15:16 (NKJV) “Your words were found, and I ate them, And Your word was to me the joy and rejoicing of my heart; For I am called by Your name, O LORD God of hosts.” When we devour His Word it produces joy because the Word becomes more real than our circumstances. The Word of the Lord is the highest form of reality.

His Word say's in Nehemiah 8:10 (NKJV) **"The joy of the LORD is your strength."**

1 Peter 1:7-9 (NKJV) ***"the genuineness of your faith, being much more precious than gold that perishes, though it is tested by fire, may be found to praise, honor, and glory at the revelation of Jesus Christ, ⁸whom having not seen you love. Though now you do not see Him, yet believing, you rejoice with joy inexpressible and full of glory, ⁹receiving the end of your faith—the salvation of your souls."***

Jack Hayford said, *"Worship changes the worshiper into the image of the One worshiped"*

IV. KEEP ON KEEPING ON...

When the Angel is still present in the house, keeping sight of the promise and maintaining excitement is no problem. When the Angel leaves the house, never to return, it is not long until one must step up to the plate and walk by faith as all the adrenalin has drained from the encounter with the Angel! This no doubt happened to Mary and it will inevitably happen to us! Franklin D. Roosevelt said, *"When you come to the end of your rope, tie a knot and hang on."*

On the strength of one appearance from an Angel

Mary: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Received an unprecedented assignment from Gabriel...
- As an unwed mother carried a baby to full term...
- Accepted the pressure of negative publicity which would change her life forever...
- Assumed the responsibility of raising Gods own Son...
- Faithfully discharged her duties for thirty three and one half years...

Oftentimes the memory of the Angel and what he has said grows very faint in our minds. Think of this:

Gabriel not only made himself scarce, visiting only once, he only spoke one hundred fifty seven words during his conversation with Mary! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

To place this in proper perspective, Gabriel and Mary did not sit around all afternoon and carry on a conversation. The Angel showed up, made an announcement and answered one question and was then off to whatever his next assignment might have been! The average sheet of 8 ½ X 11 paper contains approximately 450 words. The angel words filled up less than a third of a sheet of typing paper, and Mary was going to be expected to take on an unprecedented task which would span three and one half decades, on

the strength of this lone conversation! How did she do it?

I believe she wrote His words down. She certainly meditated upon his words! Luke 2:19 (NKJV) ***“But Mary kept all these things and pondered them in her heart.”*** The word “pondered” comes from the Greek word “Sumballo” and means “To confer with oneself.” I think Mary rehearsed the meeting with Gabriel until she could quote the conversation word for word. Habakkuk 2:2-4 (NKJV) ***“And the LORD answered me, and said, Write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.***
³For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.
⁴Behold, his soul which is lifted up is not upright in him: but the just shall live by his faith.”

Time has a way of dulling our senses and if the Word of the Lord is not written out we possess the ability to alter the instructions and adjust the destination. If the Word of the Lord is in writing, it is what it is, and we just keep on keeping on! **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** We must keep on plodding, not plotting, plodding!

In thirty three and one half years Mary probably wore the tablet the encounter with the angel was written on,

completely out. Mary knew her path would not be easy but she was determined to keep on keeping on!

John Quincy Adams said, *“Patience and perseverance have a magical effect before which difficulties disappear and obstacles vanish.”*

If we will keep on keeping on, the Lord will surely perform His promise! James 1:2-8 (KJV) ***“My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations; ³Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience. ⁴But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing. ⁵If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him. ⁶But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed. ⁷For let not that man think that he shall receive any thing of the Lord. ⁸A double minded man is unstable in all his ways.”***

Sometimes when we receive a Word from the Lord and it appears it is too far-fetched we immediately become overanxious. Over-anxiousness and lack of patience often cause complications that delay or terminate the promise which the angel has made.

I want us to consider the high cost of over-anxiousness: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- **Moses and Aaron...** Numbers 20:1-5 (NKJV)
*"Then the children of Israel, the whole congregation, came into the Wilderness of Zin in the first month, and the people stayed in Kadesh; and Miriam died there and was buried there.² Now there was no water for the congregation; so they gathered together against Moses and Aaron.³ And the people contended with Moses and spoke, saying: "If only we had died when our brethren died before the LORD!⁴ "Why have you brought up the assembly of the LORD into this wilderness, that we and our animals should die here?⁵ "And why have you made us come up out of Egypt, to bring us to this evil place? It is not a place of grain or figs or vines or pomegranates; nor is there any water to drink." Moses is told to gather the people together and take his rod to the meeting, but this time rather than striking the rock, he is to speak to it! (A rock followed them, *"and that rock was Christ"*) Notice what he does. Numbers 20:10-11 (NKJV) *"And Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock; and he said to them, "Hear now, you**

rebels! Must we bring water for you out of this rock?"¹¹ **Then Moses lifted his hand and struck the rock twice with his rod; and water came out abundantly, and the congregation and their animals drank."** Look at what Moses

over-anxiousness cost him. Numbers 20:12

(NKJV) ***"Then the LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron, "Because you did not believe Me, to hallow Me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land which I have given them."*** Why such

stringent punishment for such a seemingly insignificant infraction? First of all, over-anxiousness is a sin, and the Holiness of God always demands a penalty for sin. Secondly, the rock in the wilderness represented Jesus, and Moses had already smitten the rock once at the instruction of God. The first striking of the rock was a type of the crucifixion of Christ. Once the rock was smitten it should never have been struck again, because once Christ died he can then be spoken to as a High Priest.

- **Naaman...** Naaman was a high ranking official in the military forces of the King of Syria, but he was a leper. The wife of Naaman had a servant who was a little Hebrew girl and she told her master that there was a prophet in Samaria by the name of Elisha who could cure Naaman of his leprosy. Naaman heeds her

advice and attempts to seek Elisha out. Elisha refuses to meet with Naaman personally but sends him instruction to dip seven times in the river Jordan. Notice the response of Naaman. 2 Kings 5:11-12 (NKJV) ***"But Naaman became furious, and went away and said, 'Indeed, I said to myself, 'He will surely come out to me, and stand and call on the name of the LORD his God, and wave his hand over the place, and heal the leprosy.'12 'Are not the Abanah and the Pharpar, the rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? Could I not wash in them and be clean?' So he turned and went away in a rage."*** Because of his over-anxiousness, he almost missed his miracle.

The only time Mary exhibited over-anxiousness was when Jesus was twelve years old and stayed behind in the Temple. She said, ***"Why have you dealt thus with us?"*** The reason we do not hear anything from Jesus from the time He was twelve until the time He was thirty is because He was grounded!!!!!!

Over-anxiousness often prevents us from realizing the finality of our promises. The old song says *"Don't give up on the brink of a miracle."* I can't help but wonder how many times I have stopped just short of a tremendous victory? James 1:2-4 (KJV) ***"My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations; 3 Knowing this, that the trying of your***

faith worketh patience. 4 But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing."

Patience here is referred to as "*her*". The reason patience is referred to in this way is because it is a virtue that has the power to give birth to a promise. Robert Frost said, "*The best way out, is always through.*"

The song writer said "*Don't give up on the child of God; he'll be there when the battle is over. He will make it through the storm; find his way through the darkest night. Don't give up; don't give up on the child of God.*"

Mary did not allow herself the luxury of over-anxiousness; she was determined to keep on keeping on.

In business the foundation of success is location, location, location! The building of a successful corporation is leadership, leadership, leadership! **The key to completing the process of a promise is patience, patience, patience! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** Marian Wright Edelman said, "*You just need to be a flea against injustice. Enough committed fleas biting strategically can make even the biggest dog uncomfortable and transform even the biggest nation.*"

Good things come to those who persist! We must learn to be persistent and wait on the Lord! Isaiah 40:29-31 (CEV) ***"The LORD gives strength to those who are weary. 30 Even young people get tired, then stumble and fall. 31 But those who trust the LORD will find new strength. They will be strong like eagles soaring upward on wings; they will walk and run without getting tired."*** (Children of Israel - 11 day's journey - 40 year trip) (Abraham - Sarah - Son Isaac) Mary Kay Ash said, *"Aerodynamically the bumblebee shouldn't be able to fly, but the bumblebee doesn't know that so it goes on flying anyway."*

We cannot rush our promise or destiny; we must accept it and be willing to wait on it. God will do it, but He will do it in His own sweet time! Keep on keeping on!

CONCLUSION:

If we are going to keep on keeping on once the angel has left the house we must : **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Guard against losing our nerve to follow through with the commitment which we have made...
- Guard against forfeiture of the promise by encouraging ourselves in the Lord...

- Guard against allowing the enemy to keep us from worshipping our way through our trial...
- Guard against the pressure of fatigue by keeping on keeping on...